

MBA27 Advanced Supply Chain Management

Disclaimer: Please note that this is a draft version of the course outline which is intended to serve as a reference during your advanced course selection. It has not been formally approved yet. The final version will be shared in the respective Canvas site once it's ready.

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FACULTY INFORMATION

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FACULTY BIO



Cynthia Qingxia Kong is Associate Professor at Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus University, the Netherlands. Earlier, she was assistant professor at Universidad Adolfo Ibanez, Santiago de Chile. Her research focuses on healthcare operations management, public health management, medical decision-making, and behavioral (non-rational) decision-making using multiple-disciplinary methods such as stochastic optimization, robust optimization, data analytics, lab experiments, and surveys. Cynthia publishes in leading management journals such as

Management Science and Operations Research and leading medical journals such as Social Science & Medicine.

<https://www.rsm.nl/people/cynthia-qingxia-kong/>



Frank Rozemeijer holds the SOLVINT chair in Procurement and Supply Chain Management at the School of Business and Economics, Maastricht University, where he is supervising PhD research and responsible for the MSc course 'Strategic Sourcing' and active in several Executive Education programs. His research focuses on Procurement strategy, leadership & organization, digital transformation (impact of AI), team creativity, and buyer-supplier collaboration. Next to his academic work, Frank acts as an independent consultant and trainer for international companies. Further, he is member of the Supervisory Board of INKA, a Group Purchasing Organization in the construction industry. Over the past 20 years, he has built a strong international reputation as conference speaker and facilitator of in-company seminars. He published multiple articles in JPSM, JSCM, IMM, IJOPM and IJPDLM. In 2022, his book *'Procurement and Supply Chain Management'* (co-authored with Arjan van Weele) was published by Cengage and in 2023 it was awarded Best Book in its category in France. In 2026 the 9th edition of this book will be published. More information can be found on his website www.frankrozemeijer.com and LinkedIn (<https://www.linkedin.com/in/frank-rozemeijer-a37909/>).

ABSTRACT

"Firms no longer compete; supply chains do": Recent geopolitical events and natural disasters have once again illustrated the dependence of businesses and society as a whole on global supply chains and resilient operations. The central argument in this course is that supply chain management is essential for any organisation - whether in manufacturing or service industries or the public sector – and we will illustrate this by using readings, cases, and guest speakers from a variety of industries. In the end, we will argue, supply chain management is about successfully serving the final customer.

EDUCATIONAL GOALS

This course is not just suitable for participants that aim for a career in operations and supply chain management, but also for participants seeking a career in general management or consultancy: more broadly, anyone who believes that understanding and being able to improve the primary processes of an organisation is beneficial to one's career.

The course consists of two main blocks of five lectures each: 1) Purchasing and supply management, where the focus is on "upstream" relations in the supply chain, and 2) Managing customer demand and service levels, where the focus is predominantly on "downstream" supply chain relations. In both blocks, we build on elements from the core Operations Management course.

Purchasing and Supply Management (Frank Rozemeijer)

If you still think procurement is only about cost savings, you are missing one of the most powerful levers in modern business. The objective of this block is to provide students with the key concepts and frameworks that transform purchasing and supply management (PSM) into a driver of both financial performance and strategic growth. At its core, PSM is about how organizations acquire and manage critical inputs (i.e. goods and services). But leading firms go far beyond transactional buying. They leverage category management, strategic sourcing and supplier relationship management (SRM) to unlock value, foster innovation and build resilient, sustainable supply networks. In this block, you will learn how to design and execute high-impact category sourcing strategies, manage supplier relationships as strategic assets and harness digital technologies. We will explore how procurement contributes not only to cost efficiency (bottom line), but also to revenue growth (top line). In other words, buying organizations should identify and improve the revenue-generating potential of both suppliers and the acquired inputs. In parallel, buying organisations have increasingly become aware of the impact that procurement and suppliers have on environmental social and governance (ESG) business aspects.

The 5 lectures in this block will be devoted to the following specific topics:

- A strategic perspective on purchasing and supply management
- Unlocking business value through category management and strategic sourcing
- Supplier Relationship Management (SRM): Leveraging suppliers for competitive advantage
- Co-innovation and digital transformation of buyer-supplier relations
- Leading procurement with purpose: driving ESG impact and managing ethical dilemma's

Managing Customer Demand and Service Levels (Cynthia Kong)

The objective of this block is to provide a decision perspective and address long-term, medium, and short-term planning and control issues in both product and service-driven supply chains, such as selecting supply chain contracts, adopting an appropriate inventory management policy, and managing supply chain performance to meet customer service levels. In addition, the block also provides exposure to some basic management tools and prepares future managers to use the results of analyses to improve firm's operational performance. Some of the materials, assignments, cases, etcetera will be mathematical.

The lectures in this block will be devoted to the following specific topics:

- Managing key trade-offs in supply chain management
- Perishable product inventory management
- Supply chain coordination and collaboration
- Role of Blockchain and IoTs in supply chain logistics
- Aligning supply chain functions to attain a performance objective
- Frontiers in supply chain management

Learning areas	Educational Goals
I. Content- related	Understand how the nature and value of supply chain management can vary for different types of goods and services
	Understand how supply chain functions and resources can be aligned to achieve customer service levels
	Understand the role of purchasing and supply management in the value chain
	Understand the value of different forms of supplier relationships, and the different ways to select, develop and manage suppliers
II. Skills-related	Analyse trade-offs among alternate inventory management policies
	Define supply chain performance measures and set appropriate resources
	Define and apply differentiated category sourcing strategies
III. Attitude-related	Working together in cross-functional teams to address supply chain management challenges through coordinated decision-making
	Awareness of the challenges for successful change management in SCM

FIT WITHIN THE RSM ERASMUS MBA AND RELATION TO THE RSM MISSION: A FORCE FOR POSITIVE CHANGE*

Supply Chain Management, and its related processes both upstream and downstream in the value chain, can have a crucial impact on environmental and social sustainability aspects. For instance, the majority of most organisations' greenhouse gas emissions relate to the production and consumption processes at suppliers and customers (Scope III). In this course, we address how organisations can design and manage supply chains not just for economic performance, but also to enhance sustainability – in particular to the UN Sustainable Development

Goals 8 (Decent work and Economic Growth) and 12 (Responsible consumption and Production). We also address business ethics, in particular in relation to procurement.

Other electives in the Supply Chain Management concentration completely focus on sustainability aspects.

Distribution of Positive Change topics:

Description	Total
Environment	6 hours
Social	3 hours
Governance	3 hours
Other	-
Total hours	12 hours

* It's RSM's mission to be a force for positive change in the world. For this, RSM is committed to the United Nation's [17 Sustainable Development Goals](#) as the framework for defining 'positive change'. For the purpose of the RSM Erasmus MBA, we strive to provide our students with the opportunity to master competencies that enable them to successfully lead teams, business units and organizations while they navigate and accelerate transitions towards more just, sustainable and resilient societies. We report the amount of lecture time across all of our MBA courses that is devoted directly to such mission-relevant learning. We have further broken this down into environment, social, and governance related topics.

TEACHING METHODS AND WORKLOAD

We use a mix of teaching methods, including lectures, practitioner guest lectures, teaching cases, team assignments and individual assignments. The workload of the 4 EC credits is roughly distributed as follows:

Description	Calculation	Total
Class sessions	10 x 3 hours	30 hours
Excursion		8 hours
Pre-readings incl. in-class cases	10 x 3 hours	30 hours
TFC simulation game	6+4+2+2 hours	14 hours
Teaching case assignment(s)	3 x 4 hours	12 hours
Quiz preparations	4 x 1.5 hour	6 hours
Final Individual Assignment		12 hours
Total Course Hours		112 hours
EC (4)	4 x 28	112 hours

GRADING AND ASSESSMENT

Course: Advanced SCM	Assessment formats					
Learning outcomes	TFC	Teaching cases	Quizzes (4)	Participation	Final assignment	Total
After following this course, the student is able to:						
Understand how the nature and value of supply chain management can vary for different types of goods and services	X	X	X	X	X	
Understand how supply chain functions and resources can be aligned to achieve customer service levels	X	X	X	X	X	
Understand the role of purchasing and supply management in the value chain	X	X	X	X	X	
Understand the value of different forms of supplier relationships, and the different ways to select, develop and manage suppliers	X	X	X	X		
Analyse trade-offs among alternate inventory management policies		X		X		
Define supply chain performance measures and set appropriate resources	X		X	X	X	
Define and apply differentiated purchasing (category) strategies			X	X		
Working together in cross-functional teams to address supply chain management challenges through coordinated decision-making		X			X	
Awareness of the challenges for successful change management in SCM	X	X		X	X	
Weighting factor	20%	30%	25%	NA	25%	100%
Minimum grade required	NA	5.5	5.5	Pass	5.5	5.5
When failed, resit option within academic year (Yes/No)	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	
Form of Assessments (e.g. MC, Open-book, etc.)	See manual	See manual	MC	Pass/Fail See manual	See manual	
Group / Individual assessment (Group/Individual)	Group	Group	Individual	Individual	Individual	

In order to pass the course, each assessment or deliverable (component grade) needs to be at least 5.5, except the components for which there is no resit opportunity.

Grades are rounded according to the rounding provisions included in the Examination Regulations (ER) of the programme and are expressed with 1 decimal point. Not meeting the minimum grade required for either a component grade or the overall course grade determines a fail for the course. Participants can resit a failed component only once. There is no capping of the grade for a resit examination, unless determined by the faculty. The only exception is when the nature of the failed assignment allows for an improvement effort of the same assignment (capped at 5.5 for that component). For this course, faculty has decided that a resit for the teaching

cases and quizzes will take the form of a new assignment (i.e., new case(s) and new quiz(zes). The resit for the final assignment will be in the form of an improvement effort (and therefore, only that resit grade will be capped at 5.5).

Grade penalties for unauthorised late submissions will be automatically imposed. Penalties for unauthorised late submissions range from 10% to 20% deduction from the examination component depending on the hours/days late. Unauthorised late submissions 4 days or longer after the deadline without prior notification and a reasonable explanation for the late submission, will not be accepted.

Attendance is mandatory and a requirement to pass the course. Missing classes and arriving late may result in grading penalties and even a fail for the course.

Fraud, Plagiarism / Self-plagiarism (Refer to separate RSM Code of Conduct, Rules and Guidelines, and Teaching and Examination Regulations)

The Examination Board defines fraud as “the action or negligence of a student because of which it is impossible, entirely, or partially, to form a correct judgment about the knowledge, insight, and skills of them or another student” (R&Gs and TERs). Examples of fraud are cheating, cribbing, plagiarism, freeriding in a team assignment, availability of unauthorized (study) material during a test such as mobile phones, contract cheating/outsourcing/ghost-writing, unauthorized use of generative AI, identity fraud, theft.

Confirmed cases of fraud/plagiarism will lead to (appropriate and proportional) sanctions as defined by the Examination Board in the Rules and Guidelines (R&G). Repetitive cases of fraud/plagiarism lead to expulsion from the programme.

Plagiarism is presenting another person’s work as one’s own. Plagiarism includes any paraphrasing or summarising of the work of another person or group without acknowledgment, including submission of another student’s work as one’s own. Plagiarism frequently involves a failure to acknowledge the quotation of paragraphs, sentences, or even a few phrases written or spoken by someone else.

Using ideas from your own prior work (assignment) without referencing the work in your assignment is considered self-plagiarism.

Participants are required to adhere to the 6 principles outlined in the RSM AI guidelines with regard to the use of Artificial Intelligence Platforms such as ChatGPT and related software/tools. The unauthorised use constitutes violation of plagiarism/ fraud policy. For this particular course, the faculty promotes a **stimulated** use of AI.

For more information about academic integrity and AI please refer to the Programme’s Teaching and Examination Regulations and RSM AI guidelines documents on the [Student Hub](#) (Link).

Assessment / Deliverable:	Individual or group:	(Due) date:	% of final grade:
TFC simulation game	Group	See sessions overview	20%
Teaching case assignments (3)	Group	Case 1: 11 September @ 19:00 Case 2: 17 September @ 19:00 Case 3: 26 September @ 17:00	30 %
Quizzes (4)	Individual	Sessions 3, 5, 8, and 10	25 %
Participation	Individual	All sessions	(Pass/Fail)

Final assignment	Individual	25 October @ 23:59	25%
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For all Canvas submissions, please make sure to include the student name, EUR student number, and programme name within the document itself (on the cover page), and your initials, EUR student number, and programme name in the title of the file submission

REQUIRED TEXTBOOK(S) AND READINGS

Supply Chain Management, ISBN13: 9781292257891, by Sunil Chopra, 7th Edition, 2019.
This book will mainly be used in the second part of the course (Cynthia Kong).

Occasionally, we refer back to your textbook from the Operations Management course: Essentials of Operations Management, ISBN: 978-0-273-75619-4, by Nigel Slack, Alistair Brandon-Jones and Robert Johnston.

We provide reading materials, cases, games and other resources on-line.

Course Schedule Overview

Sessions 1-5, Purchasing and Supply Management (FR):

Thu 3 Sep, Mon 7 Sep, Mon 14, Wed 16, Mon 21 Sep – 13:30-16:30.

Sessions 6-10, Managing Customer Demand & Service Levels (CK):

Mon 22 Sep, Mon 29 Sep, Mon 06 Oct, Mon 13 Oct, Mon 20 Oct – 13:30- 16:30.

Further details below.

We will also try and plan a **company excursion at the end of September**; details will be announced at the start of the course.

DETAILED COURSE SCHEDULE

Session 1, Thursday 3 September 2026, 13:30 – 16:30 A strategic perspective on purchasing & supply management Lecturer: Frank Rozemeijer	
Topics:	• The Science of Purchasing and Supply Management (PSM): foundations and definitions • Procurement operating model: Introducing key processes (P2P, Sourcing & SRM) and enablers (people, systems and organization) • Strategic (ir)relevance of Procurement in today's wicked world • Introducing the Procurement Development Model: From buying to value chain orchestration • Assessing Procurement Excellence (prework with online tool)
In class exercises:	• Case: Shell Houston (in-class) • Pilot quiz (no grading)
Readings:	E-lectures: • ... Readings: • ... Background materials: •
Case:	Pick an organization that you have worked for, or would like to, and evaluate the Procurement function at this organization. → Use the online Procurement Maturity Assessment tool to evaluate your organization. Read the instructions and answer the questions. Make some notes of your responses, and bring these to class (no hand-in). In class we will present the overall average scores and discuss the main challenges and barriers for developing the procurement function to the next level.

Session 2, Monday 7 September 2026, 13:30 – 16:30 Unlocking value with category management & strategic sourcing Lecturer: Frank Rozemeijer	
Topics:	• Unlocking value by leveraging your scale and your suppliers • Category Management and Strategic Sourcing: what's the difference? • Developing effective category sourcing strategies • Going to the market: selecting and contracting suppliers • Value based sourcing: trading off cost, value and risks
In class exercises:	Team-work on the KFC UK case (see below)

Readings:	E-lectures: ...
Case:	Read the case “KFC UK: Don’t count your chickens before they hatch (A)” carefully before coming to class. During class, discussion questions will be shared and you will be working in teams to develop answers to the questions in the form of a PowerPoint presentation. - Teams will be requested to present (part of) their work at the end of the session. - During class, the use of any form of Generative AI is prohibited. - At the end of the session, presentations need to be submitted on email to the lecturer. - After the session, teams may modify their presentation based on the discussions and the use of Generative AI. A brief explanation should be included on why and how AI was used, and ideally also (a link to) the interaction log (prompts etc). - Presentations should contain 6 slides max in total, excluding title slide, references and supplements. - The deadline for the final submission (on Canvas) is Thursday 10 Sep, 19:00. <u>This is #1 of the three team assignments.</u>

<i>Session 3, Monday 14 September 2026, 13:30 – 16:30</i> Supplier relationship management (SRM): Leveraging suppliers for competitive advantage Lecturer: Frank Rozemeijer	
Topics:	- Leveraging suppliers as a source of competitive advantage - Segmenting business (non-)critical suppliers (Supplier segmentation) - Supplier performance management vs. Supplier development - Supplier Relationship Management (SRM): control, manage, develop and innovate - Assessing Relationship Quality with key suppliers - How to position your organization as Customer of Choice for your key suppliers?
In class exercises:	<u>In-class Quiz</u> (materials covered: readings incl. e-lectures for sessions 1, 2 & 3; slides and in-class discussion sessions 1 & 2) - In-class discussion of the Foodco case

Readings:	E-lectures: ... Readings: ... Background readings: • ...
Case:	Read the case “ FoodCo ” before coming to class. Make sure to prepare the case well. Part of the session will be devoted to working in teams on the discussion questions. Teams will be requested to present (part of) their work during the session. No hand-in.

<i>Session 4, Wednesday 16 September 2026, 13:30 – 16:30</i> Co-innovation and digital transformation of buyer-supplier relations Lecturer: Frank Rozemeijer	
Topics:	• Early Supplier Involvement (ESI) in New Product Development (NPD): Where do we stand? Where to improve? • From sourcing ‘products’ to sourcing ‘innovation capabilities’ • Boosting creativity in co-innovation: Team Creativity Climate • Digital transformation of Procurement • Impact of AI on buyer-supplier relations: experiencing a negotiation chatbot
In class exercises:	Team-work on the Radiotech case
Readings:	E-lectures: ... Readings: ... Background readings: • ...

Case:	Read the case “Radiotech” carefully before coming to class. During class, you will be working in teams to prepare for the in-class negotiation role-play. - Teams will be requested to use (part of) their work during the session. - During class, the use of any form of Generative AI is prohibited. - At the end of the session, presentations need to be submitted on email to the lecturer. - After the session, teams may modify their presentation based on the discussions and the use of Generative AI. A brief explanation should be included on why and how AI was used, and ideally also (a link to) the interaction log (prompts etc). - The presentation should contain 6 slides max in total, excluding title slide, references and supplements. - The deadline for the final submission (on Canvas) is Thursday 17 Sep, 19:00 This is #2 of the three team assignments
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<i>Session 5, Monday 21 September 2026, 13:30 – 16:30</i> Leading procurement with purpose: Driving ESG impact and managing ethical dilemmas Lecturer: Frank Rozemeijer	
Topics:	- Next Generation Procurement - Key impact of Procurement on Environmental, Social and Governance (ESG) goals - Developing sustainable supplier relationships, ensuring ethical sourcing, reducing carbon emissions (Scope 3) and enforcing labour standards. - Responsible Procurement: Dealing with ethical procurement dilemma’s - Managing Procurement: Balancing Business impact and Functional impact
In class exercises:	<u>In-class Quiz</u> (materials covered: readings incl. e-lectures for sessions 9 & 10; slides, case(s) and in-class discussion session 9) - Prepare the online Ethical Dilemmas Assessment
Readings:	Readings: TBD Background readings: ISM (2020). Principles and Standards of Ethical Supply Management Conduct with Guidelines
Case:	Prepare the online Ethical Procurement Dilemmas Assessment for in-class discussion. Deadline: Sunday 20 September 2026 13:00hrs CEST

Session 6, Tue 22 September 2026, 9:30 -12:30

Supply Chain Strategies, Performance Measures, and TFC Kick-off

Lecturer: Cynthia Kong

Topics:	- Analyzing Push-Pull Supply Chain Processes and push/pull boundaries - Understanding the performance trade-offs in a supply chain - The Fresh Connection Kick-off
In class exercises:	Read the case: Do trade-offs exist in operations strategy? Insights from the stamping die industry, and prepare answers to the following questions for in-class discussion: - What makes Lifetime, Capital, and Overtime successful companies co-exist in the same geographical area? - What challenges do you foresee for the three companies? Which company among the three do you think would sustain for a long time?
Readings:	- Managing economies of scale in a supply chain: cycle inventory, a chapter from the book: Sunil Chopra, Supply Chain Management, 2019. - Lee, Hau L., Billington, Corey (1992). Managing Supply Chain Inventories: Pitfalls and Opportunities, Sloan Management Review, 65-73.
Case:	Do trade-offs exist in operations strategy? Mark Pagell, Steve Melnyk, Robert Handfield, Do trade-offs exist in operations strategy? Insights from the stamping die industry, Business Horizons, Volume 43, Issue 3, 2000, Pages 69-77.

Session 7, Mon 28 September 2026, 13:30 – 16:30

Managing Supply Chain Inventory with Uncertain Demand (Perishable)

Lecturer: Cynthia Kong

Topics:	- Revisiting the Economic Order Quantity (EOQ) model - Strategies for re-ordering perishable commodities - Managing the optimal level of product availability for perishable commodities - Supply chain sustainability from an economic perspective - First-round Debriefing of TFC
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In class exercises:	Read the case Vasant Farm Fresh: Reducing Food Wastage and prepare answers to the following questions for the case in the form of a Powerpoint presentation (Group Assignment 3). To answer some of the questions, we assume that the purchase price is 13.86/kg, selling price is 22.51/kg, and after one day the salvage value is 4.72/kg. 1. What are the typical post-harvest concerns for farmers, and what is the role of a collection center in integrated farm supply chains and in improving fresh produce distribution? How does the supply chain network for VFF compare with traditional fresh produce distribution? 2. What revenue (per kilo) does the farmer earn on produce, and how does this compare with the total cost of the retail outlet? 3. List the product attributes and other variables influencing demand for products that affect the quantity to be procured by VFF. 4. How should VV reduce food wastage? Determine the optimal procurement quantity for cauliflower by using the daily price point for purchase and sales. Assume a one-day shelf life. Use maximum eight slides in total. Submit to the lecturer via email. Deadline: Friday 26 September, 17:00. Calculations can be discussed separately using excel spreadsheets. This is #3 of the three team assignments
Readings:	Chapter titled "Linking Product Availability to Profits" from the book: Sunil Chopra , Supply Chain Management, 2019
Case:	Vasant Farm Fresh: Reducing Food Wastage

Session 8, Mon 05 October 2026, 13:30-16:30 Newsvendor Model and Supply Chain Collaboration Lecturer: Cynthia Kong	
Topics:	• Newsvendor solutions and example applications • Supply coordination contract - revenue sharing contracts Second-round debriefing of TFC
In class exercises:	• Selected presentation on your newsvendor problem! • Excel exercises on newsvendor applications and contract • <u>In-class Quiz!</u> (covers course materials and in-class discussions in sessions 6 and 7)

Readings:	• Van der Rhee, B., Schmidt, G., van der Veen, J. A. A., Venugopal, V. (2014). Revenue-sharing contracts across an extended supply chain, <i>Business Horizons</i>, Volume 57, Issue 4, Pages 473-482. (http://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S000768131400038X) • Gürdal Ertek Crossdocking Insights from a Third Party Logistics Firm in Turkey by, in <i>Managing Supply Chains on the Silk Road Strategy, Performance, and Risk</i>, Edited by Çağrı Haksöz , Sridhar Seshadri , and Ananth V . Iyer, CRC Press 2011, Pages 141–156. • Warehouses without inventory by Kevin Gue, this article can be downloaded from https://kevingue.files.wordpress.com/2012/02/icr.pdf
Case:	n/a

Session 9, <i>Mon 12 October 2026, 13:30-16:30</i> Managing Global Supply Chain Performance and Frontiers in Supply Chain Management Lecturer: Cynthia Kong Guest lecturers: TBA	
Topics:	• Demystifying the complex port operations • Understanding the role of data and blockchains in managing global supply chains • Frontiers in Supply Chain Management • Third-round TFC Debriefing
In class exercises:	We will first discuss the findings of the Merloni case and then discuss the Maersk case. • Prepare the case “Maersk: Betting on Blockchain” and answer the following questions: • What operational challenges exist in global supply chains? • How are we overcoming the supply chain challenges with new technologies such as IoT and Blockchain? • Will the Blockchain venture solve the problems at Maersk? • Do you think joint venture will be a success? Why or why not.

Readings:	• Inclusive Deployment of Blockchain for Supply Chains: Part 1 – Introduction • Building a transparent supply chain Additional readings: • The moving parts (and the promise) of Blockchain, https://www.dcvelocity.com/dcvtv/news/5850543781001/ • Felipe Caro, Ramin Sadr, The Internet of Things (IoT) in retail: Bridging supply and demand, Business Horizons, Volume 62, Issue 1, 2019, Pages 47-54. • Real-world Examples of Blockchain Technology in the Supply Chain
Case:	Maersk: Betting on Blockchain

Session 10, Mon 19 October 2026, 13:30-16:30 Aligning supply chain objectives with organizational objectives Lecturer: Cynthia Kong	
Topics:	• How should a supply chain attain its objective? • What is an enterprise-wide unified supply chain strategy? • How do we design quick-response supply chains? • Final Debriefing of TFC
In class exercises:	<u><i>In-class Quiz!</i></u> Prepare the case “The Dabbawala System: On-time Delivery, Every Time” and answer the following questions: • How does Dabbawala organization achieve its high service performance? Why would Fedex want to mimic the operating system of Dabbawala organization? • What is the similarity between The Akshaya Patra Foundation Mid-day Meal Scheme and Dabbawala’s delivery system? • Today, we have revolutionary technologies such as the internet of things (IoT) and machine-to-machine communication. Do you think The Dabbawalas need to adopt them to scale their operations? Videos: • The Six Sigma Dabbawalas of Mumbai • Akshaya Patra’s Mega Kitchen- The Cooking Process
Readings:	Rajan Suri, It's About Time: The Competitive Advantage of Quick Response Manufacturing, 2010.
Case:	The Dabbawala System: On-time Delivery, Every Time

Session #10	Session 10, Mon 19 October 2026, 13:30-16:30 Aligning supply chain objectives with organizational objectives Lecturer: Cynthia Kong	
	Topics:	• How should a supply chain attain its objective? • What is an enterprise-wide unified supply chain strategy? • How do we design quick-response supply chains? • Final Debriefing of TFC
	In-class exercises:	<u>In-class Quiz!</u> Prepare the case “The Dabbawala System: On-time Delivery, Every Time” and answer the following questions: • How does Dabbawala organization achieve its high service performance? Why would Fedex want to mimic the operating system of Dabbawala organization? • What is the similarity between The Akshaya Patra Foundation Mid-day Meal Scheme and Dabbawala’s delivery system? • Today, we have revolutionary technologies such as the internet of things (IoT) and machine-to-machine communication. Do you think The Dabbawalas need to adopt them to scale their operations? Videos: • The Six Sigma Dabbawalas of Mumbai https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-K-QlwXoGHE • Akshaya Patra’s Mega Kitchen- The Cooking Process https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=USBh588MNbk
	Readings:	Rajan Suri, It's About Time: The Competitive Advantage of Quick Response Manufacturing, 2010.
	Case:	The Dabbawala System: On-time Delivery, Every Time

ASSIGNMENTS DESCRIPTION

The Fresh Connection (TFC):

TFC is a web-based learning environment built around a cross-functional business simulation with the aim of providing holistic experiential learning of supply chain management aspects. Together with your teammates, you will be in charge of The Fresh Connection, a loss-making virtual producer of fruit juices. You will make strategic and tactical decisions related to strategic supply chain issues. The central entity in the simulation is TFC serving retail and out-of-home channels. In teams of four participants, players assume the role in the new management team of TFC in the functions of VP Purchasing, VP Sales, VP Operations, and VP Supply Chain (and potentially a fifth person as the role of CEO, responsible for the coordination between the functions). The adapted simulation for this course runs in three rounds, whereby each round represents a decision horizon of six months. The focus of the game will be very much on strategic and tactical management decisions.

Group assignments:

There will be three group assignments on teaching cases, in the form of short slide decks. See the respective sessions for more details.

Quizzes:

The quizzes are designed to encourage you to study the preparation materials. Each (online) quiz consists of 10 multiple-choice questions, which cover the pre-reading materials and lecture slides of the previous sessions (since the previous quiz), and the pre-readings of the current session. For an online quiz, you can use a smartphone or tablet (but not a laptop). A pilot quiz will take place in the first session. Background readings are not required preparation materials for the quizzes.

Participation quality:

The three main criteria to judge effective class participation for grading are:

- Are points made relevant to the current discussion? Is the participant a good listener? Do comments clarify/elaborate on earlier comments and lead to a clearer understanding?
- Do the comments show evidence of preparation of the session materials?
- Are the comments creative and distinctive, or are all comments “middle-of-the-road”?

Half-way through the course, we provide you with an indication if the quality of your participation is average, above, or below.

Final individual assignment:

At the end of the course, there is an individual assignment in the form of an essay. This essay aims to have you apply the models and concepts you learned in this course to the Fresh Connection (TFC) company. For this assignment, you take one of the four roles in TFC game, i.e., the VP of Purchasing, Sales, Operations, or Supply Chain. You may naturally pick the role you played in the game, but you may choose another one. Focus on one or multiple challenges that you/your team were facing and trying to improve; how did you go about it, what analyses were done, what information was missing – or overlooked, and what could have been done differently, according to the course materials/lectures/discussions? We will provide more specific instructions during the course. The report should be no more than 1,200 words (excluding appendices).

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